Before you prompt ChatGPT, give it these 5 files

If your assistant doesn't know your tone, offers, and audience—it's guessing.

ALEX MCFARLAND

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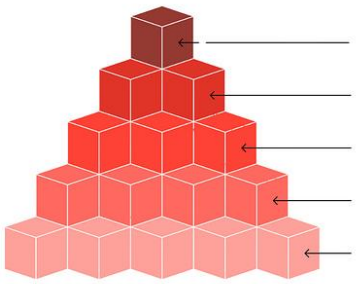
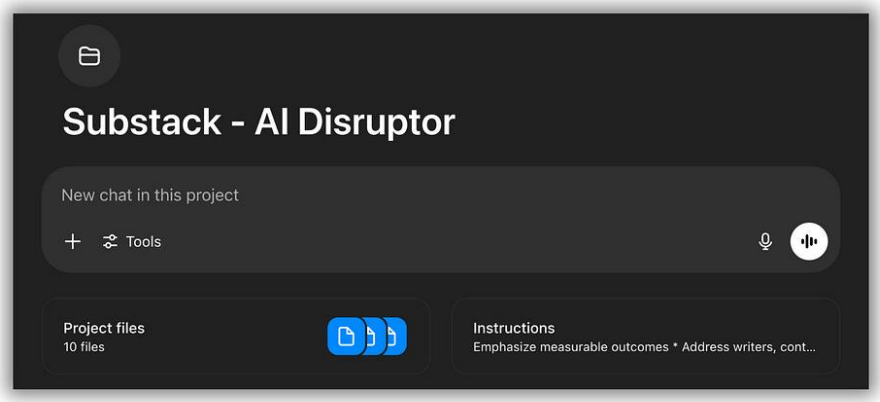




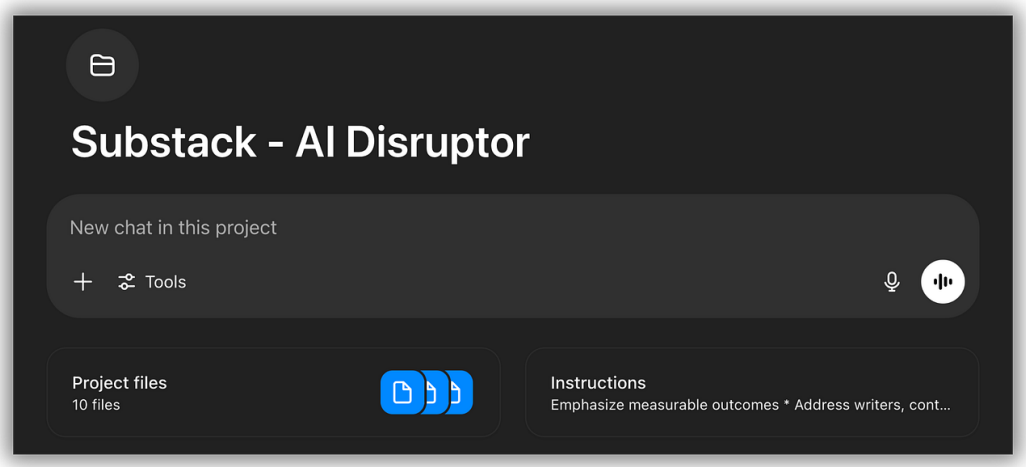
Most people use ChatGPT like a vending machine.

Drop in a clever prompt. Wait for something shiny.

That's not an AI system.

Pro AI users don't operate this way. They don't only rely on one-shot prompts or hope for magic each time.

They build **project knowledge**—structured, reusable context that gives their assistant the information it actually needs to write like them, think like them, and deliver publish-ready work.



Today, I'll show you the five foundational documents I recommend every serious AI user create.

The core ingredients your system can't perform without.

What is project knowledge?

Project knowledge is the set of documents that give your ChatGPT (or other AI model) real context.

It's not a dumping ground for PDFs or scattered notes. It's a curated set of files that encode:

- Your tone
- Your strategy
- Your products
- Your audience
- Your positioning

Once built, this foundation becomes the thinking layer your assistant draws from across posts, clients, formats, and tasks.

This is what makes workflows scalable.

The 5 project knowledge docs every serious AI system should have

1. Brand documents

Teach your assistant how you sound and what you stand for.

Your AI won't learn your voice from a single blog post. This doc gives it the full picture:

- Your About page or short bio
- Voice and tone breakdown: how you speak, what you avoid, where you lean edgy or formal
- A few sample pieces that actually *sound* like you (write some if you don't have any yet)
- Optional: brand playbooks or writer briefs for any clients you work with

Think of this as your assistant's onboarding packet. Without it, it's just guessing.

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2. Strategy documents

Give it the ability to write with intention, not just completion.

These docs encode how you think about content, growth, and positioning:

- Growth systems: hooks, subject line formulas, launch cadences

- Research or synthesis on audience building, monetization trends
- Formatting styles or content frameworks you actually use

These are the docs that keep your assistant sharp, especially when drafting headlines, writing intros, or structuring persuasive flows.

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3. Digital product library

Your assistant can't sell what it doesn't understand.

If you're selling digital products (like courses, templates, or memberships), your assistant needs this context to connect content to conversion.

Include:

- Your full product list with names, pricing, positioning
- Sales page copy or offers you've run before
- CTA logic, upsells, bonuses, and funnel elements

This is how your assistant starts writing with monetization in mind, not just "value."

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4. Customer data

Show it how your market actually talks.

Forget fictional personas. Show your assistant the real language your customers use:

- Testimonials (from emails, product reviews, DMs)
- Buyer objections from sales calls or chats

- FAQs and common questions
- Anything from live interactions that reveals emotion or friction

These aren't just good for copy. They also help your assistant generate insights, validate pain points, and write more convincingly.

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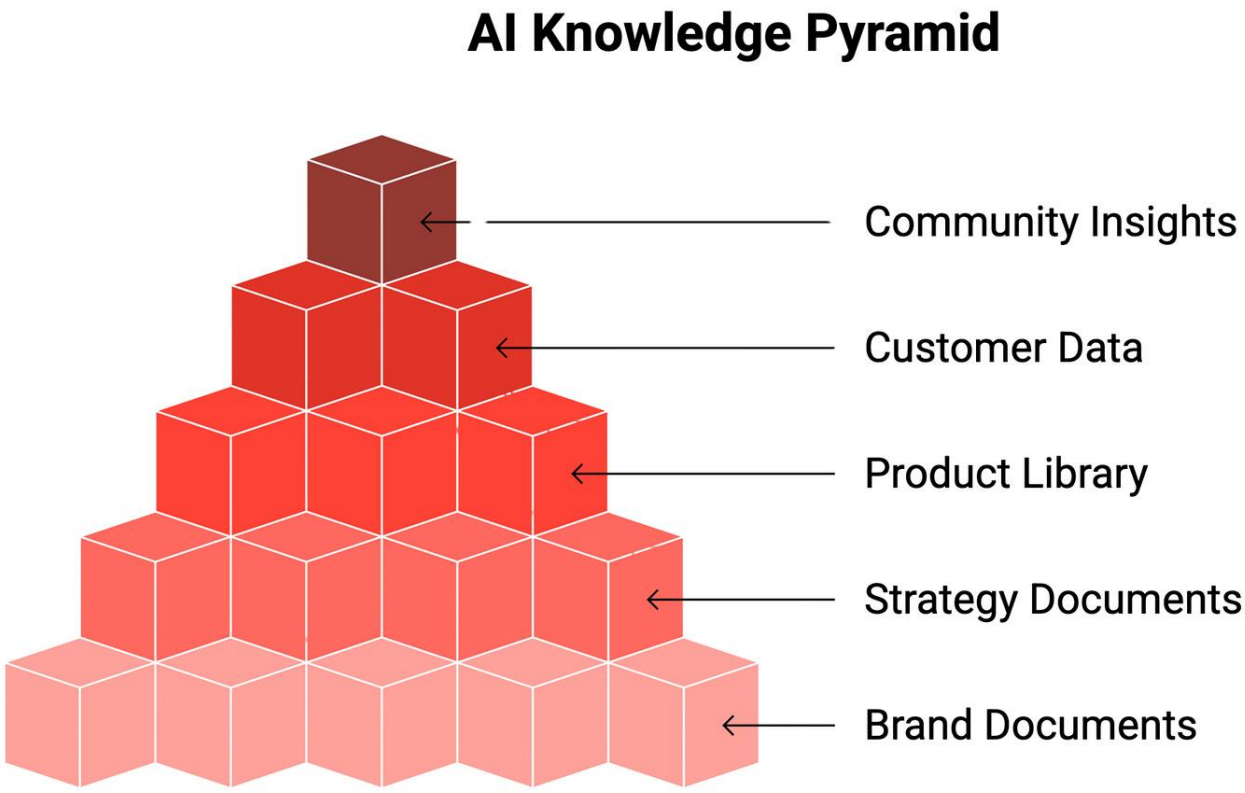
5. Community insights

Surface what your audience actually cares about.

Over time, your audience gives you feedback in subtle ways. Capture it.

- Post comments
- Replies to your newsletters
- Reader questions, note responses, and curiosity gaps
- Social replies and threads

This is how your assistant learns what to double down on and what to drop.



Why this turns into a system

Project knowledge is persistent.

When your assistant has access to this kind of structured context, you stop having to start from scratch. You stop rewriting everything. You start collaborating.

This is the infrastructure that supports **Pillar 2—Co-write with AI**.

Because now your assistant has what it needs to:

- Match your tone
- Support your products
- Reinforce your positioning
- Write to your audience (not just for them)

This is how AI stops being a novelty and becomes part of your actual creative process.

Quick-start: Build one doc today

Don't overthink it. Here's the move:

- Pick one of the five doc types above
- Gather 1–2 pieces of content you've already written
- Drop them into a clearly labeled doc
- Save it in a ChatGPT or Claude project

That's the first step toward a system.